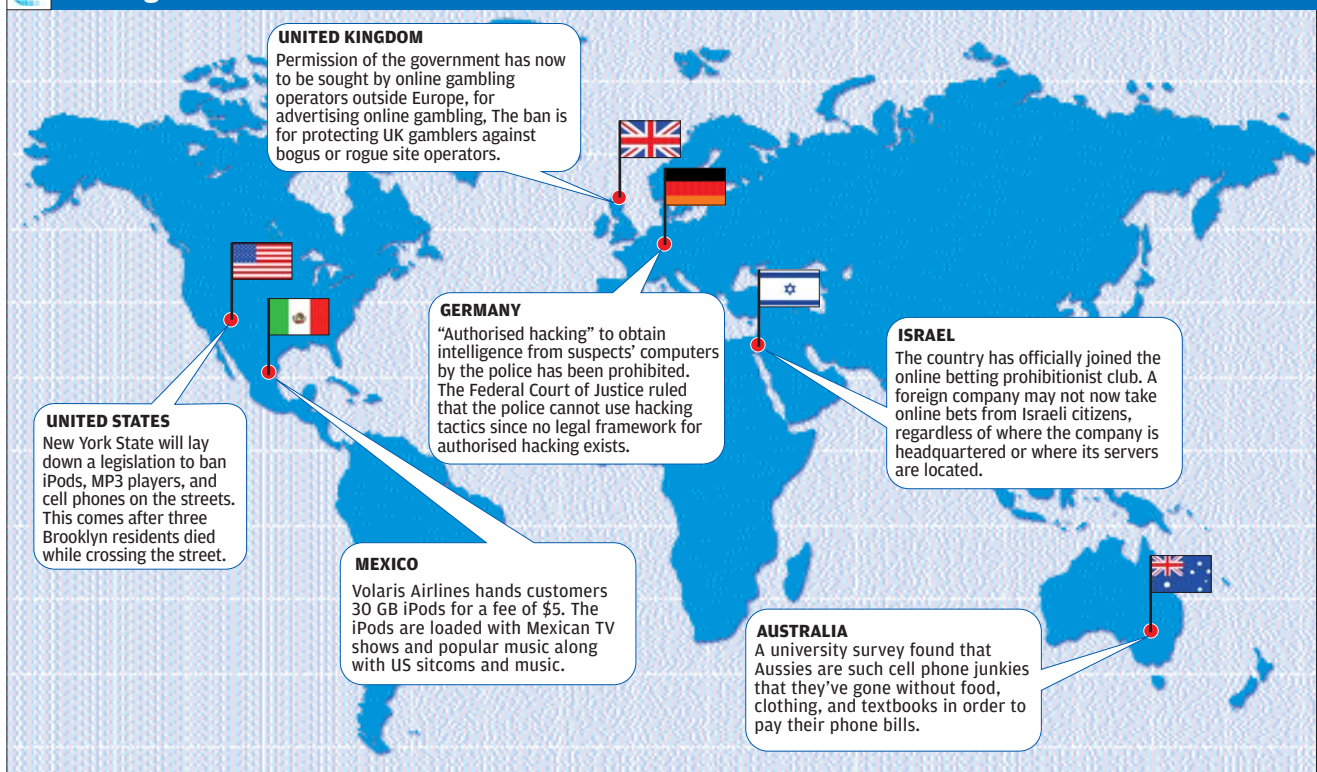


The Digital World

A Round-up Of Technology News From Across The Globe



have the company remove Windows! Now that's just the cost of formatting your PC—they won't load Linux for you!

We've heard of extreme measures being adopted to combat piracy, but this one takes the cake! Hopefully, with Vista's new phone-home type security, which almost forces you to uninstall it if you haven't paid for it, will get rid of such ridiculous policies.

For those of you who are interested in knowing where India stands on the piracy list, don't worry, we aren't in the top 20. However, with 72 per cent piracy, and an ever growing number of users buying assembled PCs, we will have to spread awareness if we want to avoid being put on the list of shame!

One thing you need to remember is that this 72 per cent figure means that for every 100 Indian users who buy a computer, only 28 buy genuine software. So according to BSA, even though Vietnam tops the list of shame in terms of percentage, it is not the

country with the most PCs running on pirated software. Take China for example: studies and estimates put the number of Internet accessing users in China (not PC owners), stand at around 120 million.

Let's apply BSA's stats to this figure: $86\% \times 120 \text{ million} = 103.2 \text{ million}$ Chinese users run pirated software. Compare this figure to Vietnam's *entire* population of 84 million humans, and you should get what we're saying...

VIRTUAL BUSINESSES

Second Life Madness

It's *Second Life* time again. There was a competition in *Second Life*; the objective was to come up with business plans and ideas that were implementable in *Second Life*. The winners were announced late February, and the top honours went to Market Truths, a US-based market research and



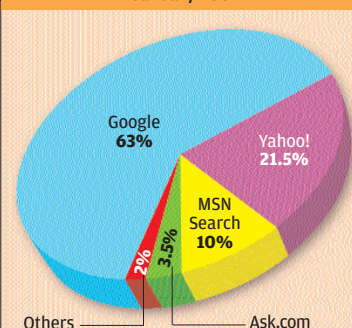
Stat Attack

It's all in the numbers

Wikipedia broke into the top 10 visited sites, ranking **9th** with 42.9 million unique visitors in January 2007. One year ago, Wikipedia was **33rd**!

About **85 million digital cameras** were sold in 2006—and **500 million camera phones**

Percentage-wise usage of search engines in January 2007



55% of online teens have a personal profile.
55% have used social networking sites.
48% of teens visit social networking sites **daily or more often**
26% visit once a day
22% visit **several times a day**

Software companies lost **\$34 billion** in potential revenue from piracy in 2005.

InPhase Technologies' 300 GB holographic disk costs \$18,000.
Price per GB: Rs 2,700. Price per GB of a **250 GB regular hard disk:** Rs 13.
 Capacity could increase to 1.6 TB in 2010

Second Life's front page states **3.1 million** residents
15,000 people are logged in to Second Life at any time